Project 4 | charity: water Game Concept

The marketing team at charity: water wants you to mockup a game inspired by their global mission, with the goal of raising awareness among young people.

For your first deliverable, choose from the provided ideas, or come up with a game concept of your own. Then, break down what the game would look like on the screen. Plan core elements like layout, interaction, and feedback. Finally, you'll submit a wireframe or mockup of the game you intend to build.

Step 1: Choose Your Game Idea

Your goal is to decide on a game that would be fun, engaging, and doable for you to build over the next couple weeks. Choose something you'd enjoy working on, and that you would be excited to share in your portfolio later on!

Here are some ideas to get you started (feel free to go with those!) —

- **Water Quest:** A fast-paced, whack-a-mole-style game where players tap charity: water's signature yellow jerry cans to earn points. Include a score counter, feedback messages, milestones, and optional obstacles to make it more engaging.
- **Water Drop:** In this game, users collect as many falling water drops as possible while avoiding pollutants (bad drops). Users tap to collect drops before they hit the ground. Include a score counter, feedback messages, and penalties for "bad drops" to make it more engaging.

Don't like these ideas? Use AI tools to help you brainstorm a game concept, or build on the provided examples. Here's a prompt suggestion:

Try this prompt



I'm designing a simple web app game to promote charity: water's mission of providing clean water for all (see: charitywater.org). The goal is specifically to engage college students. My goal is to create something fun, **[add any specific game elements you'd like]**. It also needs to be simple enough for me to build using HTML, CSS and JS **[add any additional skills or languages]**, with my current skills **[describe skill level]** and in **[add desired time to spend]**. Help me come up with ideas. For each idea, explain the game mechanics and break down what I would need to build.

Remember, brainstorming with AI is a conversation. Be discerning about the results, and don't be afraid to ask follow up questions or correct the AI if what it is suggesting sounds too complicated.

Step 2: Wireframe Your Game

Create a visual wireframe of your game, using hand-drawing or sketching software. Your wireframe should show the key features of your game.

Think about what the player sees: title, score, buttons, progress bars, icons, or avatars. Include all elements, including those as users we take for granted, such as a 'start' button or a feedback message telling the user the game ended. These provide a roadmap for everything you would need to code later.

- **Ready for a LevelUp? (20pts extra credit)**
    - **Use a Wireframing Tool (10pts):** Try out a wireframing tool like Figma, Balsamiq, or Adobe XD (or similar) to wireframe like a pro. Many of these tools offer a free limited-time demo.

- **Wireframe For Different Devices (10pts):** Think of your game being played on mobile screens and laptops. Create wireframes for each to show how screen size will impact the layout and gameplay.

Step 3: Plan the Game Logic

Using the template provided below, write up a short explanation of how the game logic works. Ask yourself: What actions does the player take? What gets updated—score, timer, achievements? What feedback does the player get (e.g., animations, visual cues, milestone unlocks)?

Word of advice: Keep it simple — you will have opportunities to iterate and expand your game later, but done is better than perfect, and you have a deadline! Your initial goal is to get started with something that you can do.

Use AI to verify that your game logic makes sense. Here's a sample prompt:

Try this prompt



Attached is my wireframe of a web game designed to promote charity: water's mission of providing clean water for all (see: charitywater.org). My game logic includes: **[insert description]**. Does this make sense? Identify any weaknesses in my game logic or opportunities for improvement.

As your understanding of the game logic deepens, return to step 2 and adjust your wireframe, removing unnecessary elements and adding new ones.

Step 4: Add Branding

When designing a game for an organization looking to increase awareness, it's important to build the brand's assets into the design. Refine your initial sketch by adding colors, icons, and styles that align with **charity: water's brand guidelines**. If you're keeping your wireframe minimal, include notes on where the brand's colors, images, links, or icons will be incorporated.

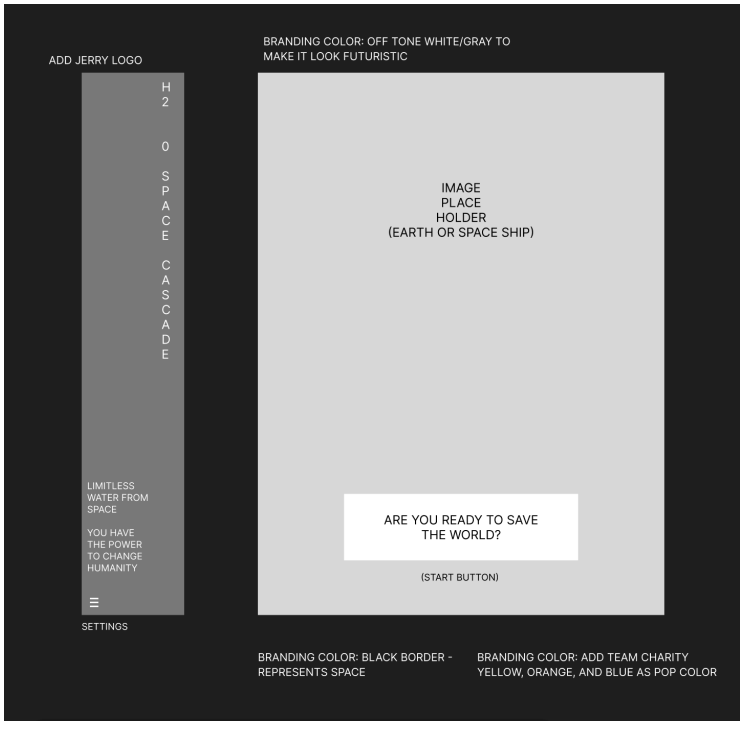
Step 5: Submit Your Work

Happy with your wireframe or mockup? Capture a clear, high-quality image of your game idea, and complete the following in order to submit your work.

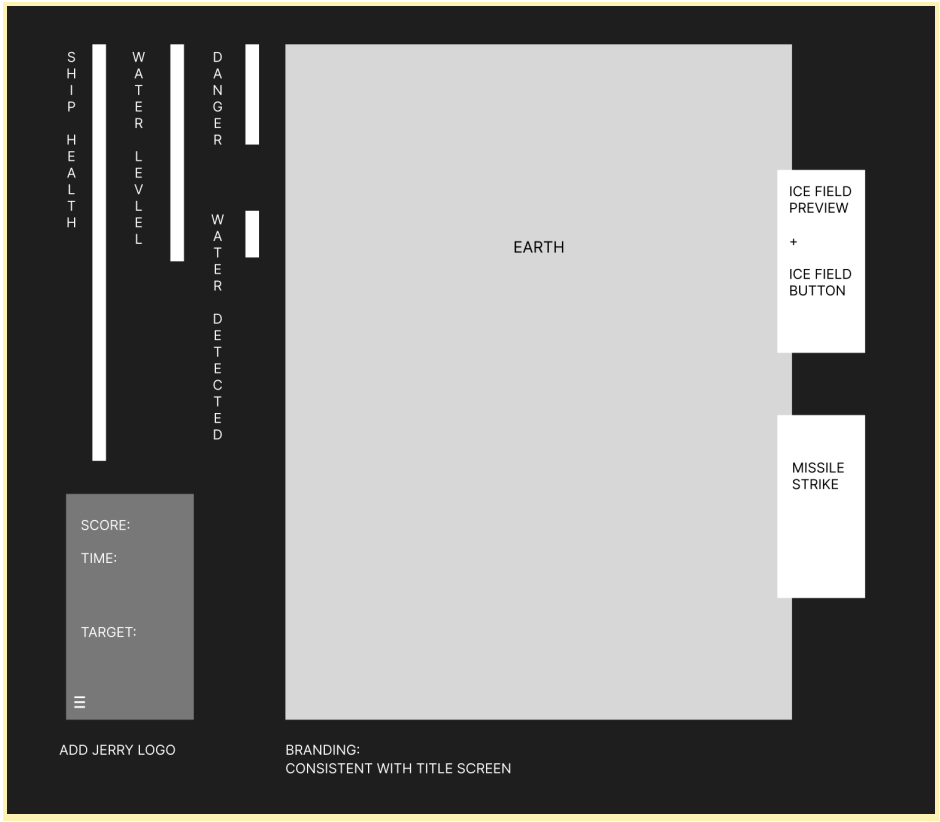
1. Let's see it! Include your game wireframe image here: **(30pt)**



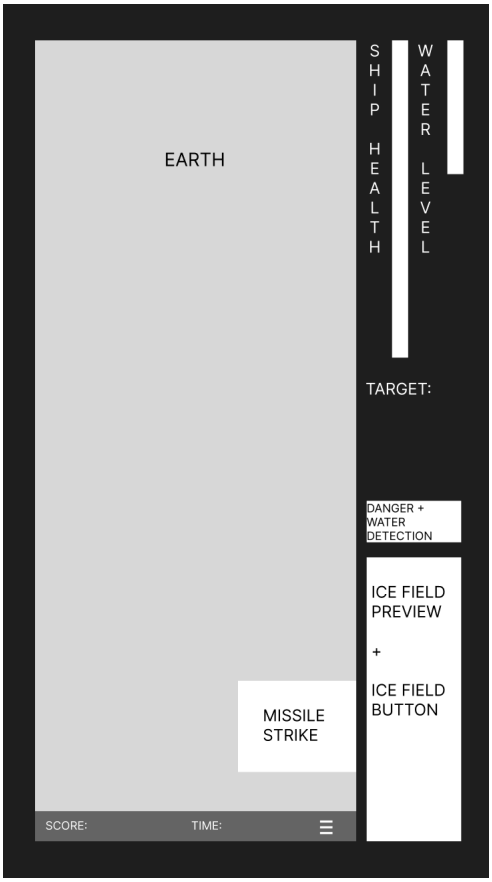
Title Screen:



Game Layout:



Mobile Layout:



1B. Did you do any of the LevelUps? To help the evaluator notice—and give you the bonus points you deserve!—, please list them here:

> I used Figma as my wireframing tool. I also created a mobile screen layout for the game.

2. Fill in the template provided below and paste in a full description of the game logic (how the game works, what users do, what happens when they do it, etc). This description should be written in a no-frills style, as if breaking down the logic that needs to be coded into the game for an engineering team. **(30pt)**

(Write your own game logic below, following the template format 👇)

H2 0 SPACE CASCADE - Game Logic:

1. Game Start:
  - What happens when the game first loads or starts?

The player sees the Earth globe and gets introduced to their mission.

  - Are any elements placed on the screen? (e.g., items, score, timer)

There is a score, a timer, an HP bar, a water level bar, and buttons for shooting ice and sending water to Earth.

2. Player Actions:
  - What can the player click, tap, move, or do?

The player can rotate the Earth globe. They can also click the ice preview to see the ice asteroid belt. Clicking on the ice shoots a bullet at it to break it apart. They can also click on the missile launch to prepare to send water to Earth. There is a settings bar too.

  - How does the game respond to those actions?

The game opens a panel when the player clicks any of these buttons, triggering a new action (other than the action that breaks the ice).

3. Game Logic:
  - What rules or conditions should the game check for?

The game should check the health bar and the water level bar. It should also check if an asteroid is too close to the ship. The game should, most importantly, check whether the player achieved a certain number of points and how much time has passed.

  - What happens when the player succeeds or fails at something?

The game will provide cues, such as audio and graphics, to indicate whether the player is doing something right or wrong. When the user wins, a celebratory screen with sound effects will appear.

4. Score/Feedback:
  - How is the score updated?

When the player successfully sends water to Earth, they earn points. Breaking the ice also earns points, which are updated in the score. Taking damage from incoming ice chunks loses points.

- What visual or audio feedback appears based on player actions?

Shooting at the ice creates a firing sound. Sending a water missile to Earth creates a rocket sound. Winning and losing also create a sound. Any button that is clicked should make a satisfying sound.

5. Win or Lose Conditions:

- How does the game end?

The game ends either when the timer ends or when the player reaches a certain score (sent water to all of the targets).

- What happens when the game ends (e.g., show a message, reset option)?

There will be a game-over message that will show a play again option. There will also be a link to Charity: Water

6. Reset/Replay:

- Can the player restart the game? What happens on reset?

The player can restart the game either by clicking restart in the options or finishing the game to get a restart option. The reset makes the whole game go back to the beginning.

3. Write up a note for your charity: water stakeholders describing your game idea. Imagine this as the body of the email that you send along with your wireframe image. Here, your writing can focus less on the nitty-gritty details, and more on the exciting elements of the game and why you believe users will love it. Highlight how and where charity: water brand assets (colors, images, link to website etc) will be incorporated. Your goal is to get them excited about your idea, and get stakeholder approval to continue building the game! **(10pt)**

(Paste or write your answer below 👇)

Dear investors,

Our game idea is called “H2 0 Space Cascade”. The basic premise of the game is sending water from space to third-world countries. The user operates a spaceship with a crew that uses a nearby ice asteroid field to fill missiles with water, which are then sent back to Earth. To make the game more interesting, incoming asteroids can damage the ship, reducing health points, which incentivizes the user to shoot at them to collect water. After filling the water to a certain level, the user can send it back to Earth to a targeted country. I believe this game will be a hit, especially with the younger generation, thanks to its interactive, exciting elements, such as shooting down asteroids and launching water missiles. Not only would the game be fun to play, but it would also teach users the need for water in third-world countries. To tie back to Charity: Water, we would use their inverted brand colors, with the monochrome palette taking up most of the space while making bright, saturated colors pop. After completing the game, a link to the Charity: Water website will appear. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Sincerely,
Aj Apolo

4. Reflect on the experience of wireframing and planning a game. What surprised you? How did you use AI to assist you? What did you learn from this experience? What would you do differently next time? **(10 pt)**

(Paste or write your answer below 👇)

I am surprised by how much wireframing helped in the design process. I usually sketch my ideas, but I did not think it would flesh them out even more. I did not use as much AI on this project as on others, but I did get great name ideas for my game. I learned that I should sketch my ideas more, especially in Figma, because it lets me pump out so many ideas, paving the way to a final product. Next time, I would rely on AI a bit more to increase efficiency, for example, in brainstorming. I thought I didn't need to use it much on this project, but having an assistant who gives me ideas would definitely help with the design process.

— Save and submit your work!

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